



Gavin Newsom, Governor  
State of California  
Health and Human Services Agency  
**DEPARTMENT OF MANAGED HEALTH CARE**  
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[www.DMHC.ca.gov](http://www.DMHC.ca.gov)

April 6, 2026

**VIA ELECTRONIC MAIL**

Lea Anna Tonkin  
Cigna HealthCare of California, Inc.  
400 N. Brand Blvd. Suite 400.  
Glendale, CA 91203

Re: Proposed Contract Termination with Lakewood IPA, Inc..  
Block Transfer Filing No. 2026-PROV-97  
Filed on March 10, 2026

Dear Ms. Tonkin:

The Department of Managed Health Care (Department) is reviewing the information in the above-referenced Block Transfer Filing (Filing) submitted by **Cigna HealthCare of California, Inc.** (Plan) for compliance with the requirements of the Knox-Keene Health Care Service Plan Act of 1975, as amended (Cal. Health & Safety Code § 1340 *et seq.*) and the regulations promulgated thereunder (Cal. Code Regs., Tit. 28, § 1000 *et seq.*).

In the event of contract termination, the Filing proposes to remove **Lakewood IPA, Inc.** (Terminating Provider Group) from the Plan's provider network. The effective date of contract termination between the Terminating Provider Group and the Plan (Termination Date) is currently **July 1, 2026**.

Please review the following comments and feel free to contact me if you would like to discuss any of the issues before filing the Plan's response.

1. The Plan stated it "confirms that the Terminating Provider Group is delegated for Utilization Management for most professional services. Accordingly, the Terminating Provider Group is responsible for issuing authorizations. As a result, the Plan does not have direct visibility into the number of affected enrollees who have been authorized or approved to receive procedures or services from providers within the Terminating Provider Group within 180 days of the termination date. However, the Plan has requested this information from the Terminating Provider Group and is currently awaiting their response."

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*Contact the DMHC Help Center at 1-888-466-2219 or [www.DMHC.ca.gov](http://www.DMHC.ca.gov)*

Can the Plan please provide the number of affected enrollees who have been authorized or approved to receive a procedure or service from a provider within the Terminating Provider Group within 180 days of the Termination Date?

2. Please indicate whether the medical groups were put on Corrective Action Plans by the Department or by the Plan.

Please submit the Plan's response by **April 9, 2026**, via the Block Transfer portal as a "Response to Comment Letter."

Please contact me if there are any questions regarding the above.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Stacie Litovchenko". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first letter of the first name being a large, stylized 'S'.

Stacie Litovchenko  
Analyst II  
Office of Plan Monitoring